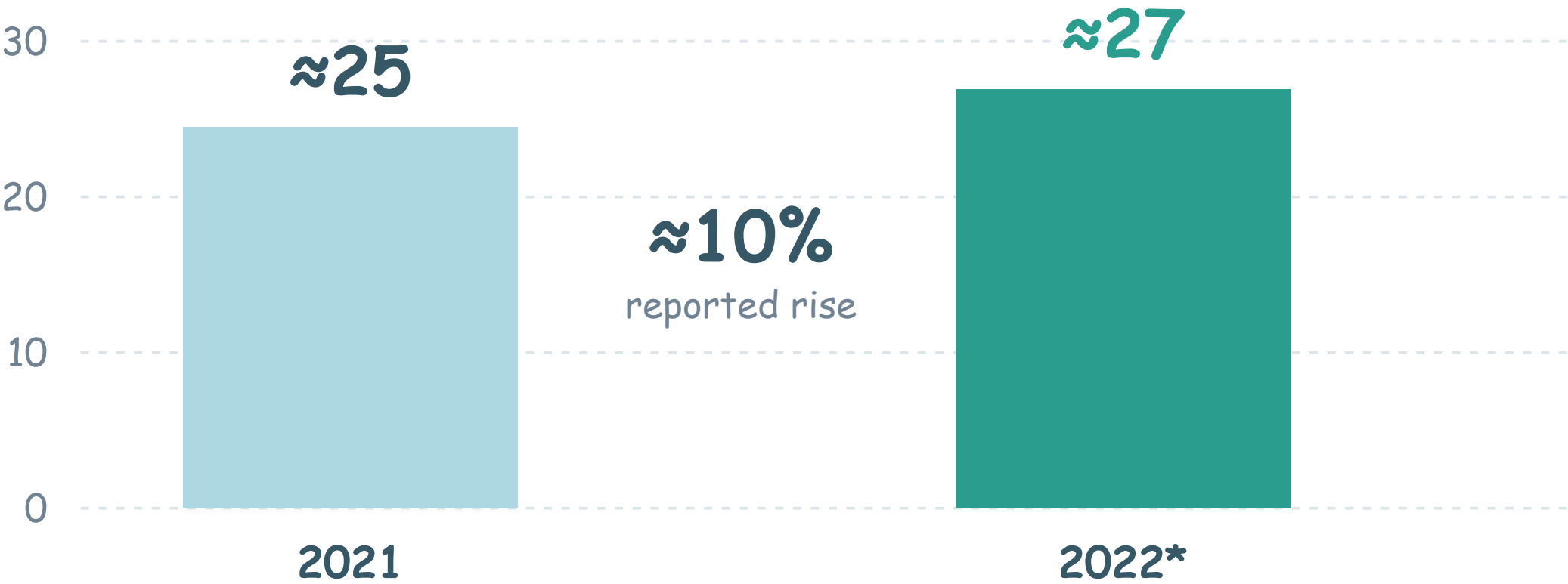


04 E-COMMERCE RELIES ON WIDER SUPPORT SERVICES

Business e-commerce in 43 economies

US\$ trillion · includes domestic and B2B sales



Reading the estimates carefully

Both years include estimated components. The 2022 business-sales total is indicative: about one third of the total is estimated.

37 major online platforms · partial coverage



US\$ transaction value · ≈55% rise reported by UNCTAD

What the two totals show

Business e-commerce sales across 43 economies rose from almost US\$25 trillion in 2021 to an indicative US\$27 trillion in 2022. The separate 37-platform compilation increased from around US\$2.6 trillion in 2019 to US\$4.0 trillion in 2021. These measures answer different questions: the scale of business e-commerce and the activity recorded by selected intermediaries. They cover different periods and activities, so they cannot be added.

Services and concentration

Six platforms account for 80% of sales in the 37-platform compilation. UNCTAD also describes payments, warehousing, delivery and analytics supplied by platforms. Our interpretation is that these intermediaries can help sellers reach customers while creating dependence on a few providers. Read alongside China’s export growth, the figures draw attention to service partners involved in overseas selling. They do not show that China caused the changes in either the multi-economy business-sales total or the platform compilation.

Source [5]: UNCTAD (2024), pp. 3-4 and 31-32. Rounded figures and source-reported growth rates. The 43-economy total includes domestic and B2B sales; 2022 is indicative. Platform coverage is partial. CC BY 3.0 IGO.